

D177

Brand Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A new plant-based yogurt brand, founded by two former chefs and sold in 300 stores, finds that most shoppers in its target market cannot recall its name or say what category it belongs to. The team wants to launch a loyalty community next month. Where should brand-building effort focus first?

- A. Brand salience: build awareness of the name and its category.
- B. Judgments: publish quality ratings.
- C. Resonance: launch the loyalty community as planned.
- D. Promote the founders' chef backgrounds as the core message.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Customers of an outdoor brand join its trail clean-up events, post about it unprompted and say they would not switch. Which level of the brand pyramid has been reached?

- A. Resonance.
- B. Feelings.
- C. Performance.
- D. Salience.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Every major airline on a route offers seat-back screens and free snacks. One regional airline, which flies 40 aircraft, is the only one with guaranteed on-time arrival or a full refund. Its crew uniforms were redesigned in spring. Which is the airline's point of difference?

- A. The redesigned crew uniforms.
- B. The on-time guarantee.
- C. Free snacks, because customers like them.
- D. Seat-back screens.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A new electric-car brand must match competitors on range and safety ratings before buyers take it seriously. What are range and safety for this brand?

- A.** Irrelevant, since only unique features matter.
- B.** Brand elements.
- C.** Points of difference.
- D.** Points of parity.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A survey of 2,000 consumers shows that a fast-food brand is instantly linked with “greasy” and “unhealthy.” The brand has the most recognizable jingle in the category. Which statement best evaluates these associations?

- A.** They build equity because they are strong.
- B.** They are weak, since consumers only associate them with food.
- C.** They are strong but unfavorable, so they weaken brand equity.
- D.** The jingle makes them favorable.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A cosmetics company wants to measure monthly changes in awareness, preference and ad recall for its main brand after a new campaign. The campaign features a well-known actress. Which research tool fits?

- A.** A celebrity-likability poll.
- B.** A tracking study.
- C.** A brand inventory only.
- D.** A one-time brand audit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A brand team suspects consumers hold associations with its 90-year-old soup brand that no one has named yet. The company is headquartered in Ohio. Which research approach should come first?

- A. Survey only Ohio consumers.
- B. A tracking study of market share.
- C. Qualitative methods such as projective techniques and depth interviews.
- D. A 5,000-person survey with fixed-choice questions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A consumer-goods company sells laundry detergent, diapers and razors under separate brand names, and its corporate name rarely appears on packaging. It was founded in the 1800s. What brand architecture is this?

- A. Branded house.
- B. Legacy brand, due to its age.
- C. Endorsed brands.
- D. House of brands.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A technology company puts its single corporate name on its phones, laptops, cloud services and bank card. What is this architecture, and what is its main risk?

- A. A house of brands; brands are insulated from each other.
- B. Co-branding.
- C. A branded house; a failure in one product can hurt the whole brand.
- D. A branded house with no risk, since the name is strong.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A premium chocolate brand with a 120-year history and a factory tour attraction is considering a line of motor oil under the same name. Research shows consumers see no link between the two. What is the main concern?

- A. It is a line extension, so risk is low.
- B. Poor fit may confuse consumers and dilute the chocolate brand.
- C. The factory tour will not support motor-oil sales.
- D. None, because a strong brand can extend anywhere.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A yogurt brand launches a new mango flavor in its existing cups. What type of extension is this?

- A. Line extension.
- B. Co-branding.
- C. Category extension.
- D. Brand revitalization.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A baby-formula maker learns that one batch may be contaminated. The company is headquartered in Minnesota and has 4,000 employees. Its legal team suggests waiting until tests finish in two weeks. What is the best first response?

- A. Wait two weeks for test results before saying anything.
- B. Blame the ingredient supplier in a press release.
- C. Issue a statement that the company never has quality problems.
- D. Recall the batch now and tell customers what is known, what is being done and what to do.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A new plant-based yogurt brand, ~~founded by two former chefs and sold in 300 stores~~, finds that most shoppers in its target market cannot recall its name or say what category it belongs to. The team wants to launch a loyalty community next month. Where should brand-building effort focus first?

Target word: pyramid level to build first **Decides:** Customers lack recognition — salience is missing.

A	Correct	The pyramid is built from the base; recall and category link come first.
B	Adjacent category	Judgments require customers to know the brand first.
C	Inverted operation	Resonance is the top of the pyramid; it cannot rest on no awareness.
D	Camouflage	Founder story is detail; the gap is basic awareness.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

Customers of an outdoor brand join its trail clean-up events, post about it unprompted and say they would not switch. Which level of the brand pyramid has been reached?

Target word: reverse: level from behavior **Decides:** Active engagement, community and loyalty.

A	Correct	Loyalty, community and active engagement define resonance.
B	Adjacent category	Emotional response is a step below resonance.
C	Confusion set	Performance is about product function.
D	Inverted operation	The base level — mere awareness.

3. Answer B Concept 2

Every major airline on a route offers seat-back screens and free snacks. One regional airline, ~~which flies 40 aircraft~~, is the only one with guaranteed on-time arrival or a full refund. ~~Its crew uniforms were redesigned in spring~~. Which is the airline's point of difference?

Target word: identify the point of difference **Decides:** Only this airline offers the guarantee.

A	Camouflage	Not described as valued or unique.
B	Correct	Unique and valued — a point of difference.
C	Dropped element	Favorable but not unique.
D	Confusion set	All rivals offer them — a point of parity.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A new electric-car brand must match competitors on range and safety ratings before buyers take it seriously. What are range and safety for this brand?

Target word: reverse: classify from the role **Decides:** Required to be credible in the category.

A	Absolute language	Without parity, differences are not credible.
B	Adjacent category	Elements are names, logos and symbols.
C	Inverted operation	Matching competitors does not set the brand apart.
D	Correct	Attributes needed to be seen as a legitimate category member.

5. Answer C Concept 3

A survey of 2,000 consumers shows that a fast-food brand is instantly linked with “greasy” and “unhealthy.” ~~The brand has the most recognizable jingle in the category.~~ Which statement best evaluates these associations?

Target word: evaluate associations **Decides:** Strong but unfavorable.

A	Dropped element	Ignores the favorability test.
B	Inverted operation	The survey shows instant (strong) links.
C	Correct	Equity requires associations that are favorable as well as strong.
D	Camouflage	Jingle recognition does not change what the associations mean.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A cosmetics company wants to measure monthly changes in awareness, preference and ad recall for its main brand after a new campaign. ~~The campaign features a well-known actress.~~ Which research tool fits?

Target word: pick the measurement tool **Decides:** Repeated measures over time.

A	Camouflage	Measures the actress, not the brand.
B	Correct	Routine, repeated measurement shows change over time.
C	Dropped element	An inventory profiles how the brand is marketed, not consumer response.
D	Adjacent category	Audits are comprehensive but periodic, not monthly.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A brand team suspects consumers hold associations with its 90-year-old soup brand that no one has named yet. ~~The company is headquartered in Ohio.~~ Which research approach should come first?

Target word: choose research method **Decides:** Goal is to uncover unknown associations.

A	Camouflage	Headquarters location does not define the sample.
B	Adjacent category	Tracks outcomes, not the meaning of associations.
C	Correct	Qualitative research uncovers associations researchers have not anticipated.
D	Inverted operation	Surveys measure known associations; they cannot surface unknown ones.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A consumer-goods company sells laundry detergent, diapers and razors under separate brand names, and its corporate name rarely appears on packaging. ~~It was founded in the 1800s.~~ What brand architecture is this?

Target word: classify the architecture **Decides:** Separate stand-alone brands with a hidden parent.

A	Inverted operation	A branded house puts one master name on everything.
B	Camouflage	Company age is not an architecture type.
C	Adjacent category	Endorsed brands show the parent visibly.
D	Correct	Each product brand stands alone.

9. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A technology company puts its single corporate name on its phones, laptops, cloud services and bank card. What is this architecture, and what is its main risk?

Target word: reverse: architecture and trade-off **Decides:** One master brand across all offerings.

A	Inverted operation	Separate names would insulate; here there is one name.
B	Confusion set	Co-branding pairs two different companies' brands.
C	Correct	Shared name spreads both equity and risk.
D	Absolute language	Shared naming concentrates risk.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A premium chocolate brand ~~with a 120-year history and a factory tour attraction~~ is considering a line of motor oil under the same name. Research shows consumers see no link between the two. What is the main concern?

Target word: evaluate a category extension **Decides:** Poor perceived fit.

A	Confusion set	A new category makes it a category extension.
B	Correct	Extensions succeed on fit; mismatches weaken the parent.
C	Camouflage	Tours are irrelevant to extension fit.
D	Absolute language	Brand strength does not overcome poor fit.

11. Answer A Concept 7 · transfer

A yogurt brand launches a new mango flavor in its existing cups. What type of extension is this?

Target word: reverse: classify from the move **Decides:** New variant in the same category.

A	Correct	Same category, new variant.
B	Adjacent category	No partner brand is involved.
C	Inverted operation	That would enter a different category.
D	Confusion set	Revitalization repositions a fading brand.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A baby-formula maker learns that one batch may be contaminated. ~~The company is headquartered in Minnesota and has 4,000 employees.~~ Its legal team suggests waiting until tests finish in two weeks. What is the best first response?

Target word: crisis first response **Decides:** Potential harm to infants — safety and speed first.

A	Inverted operation	Silence during risk magnifies harm and damage.
B	Adjacent category	Blame-shifting erodes trust.
C	Absolute language	Denial is contradicted by the facts.
D	Correct	Fast, transparent, safety-first action protects people and long-term equity.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Customer-based brand equity pyramid	Brand building climbs in order: salience (identity) → performance and imagery (meaning) → judgments and feelings (response) → resonance (relationship).	Jumping to loyalty and community (resonance) before customers even recognize the brand.	The customer's current relationship: unaware, aware, judging, or devoted.
2	Points of parity vs. points of difference	Points of parity are associations a brand must share to be a credible category member; points of difference are strong, favorable, unique associations that set it apart.	Calling a feature every competitor has a point of difference.	Whether rivals also offer the attribute.
3	Strong, favorable, unique associations	Brand associations create equity when they are strong (memorable), favorable (valued) and unique (not shared).	Treating any strong association as an asset, even an unfavorable one.	What customers recall about a brand and whether it helps or hurts.
4	Brand audit vs. tracking study	A brand audit is a periodic, comprehensive review of a brand's health (brand inventory plus exploratory research); a tracking study gathers the same measures routinely over time to spot changes.	Using a one-time audit to monitor month-to-month shifts.	Comprehensive and occasional vs. repeated and ongoing.
5	Qualitative vs. quantitative brand research	Qualitative methods (projective techniques, depth interviews) uncover the range and meaning of associations; quantitative methods (surveys) measure how strong and widespread they are.	Using a large survey to discover associations the team has not yet thought of.	Explore "why/what" versus measure "how many/how much."
6	Brand architecture	A branded house uses one master brand across offerings; a house of brands runs separate stand-alone brands; endorsed brands pair a distinct name with the parent's endorsement.	Mixing up a house of brands with a branded house.	Whether the corporate name appears on each product.
7	Brand extensions	Line extensions add variants in the same category; category extensions enter new categories. Success depends on perceived fit; poor fit can dilute the parent brand.	Assuming a strong parent brand can succeed in any category.	A known brand launching in the same or a different category.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	Brand crisis management	In a crisis, respond quickly, put safety first, accept responsibility where due and communicate transparently; delay and denial magnify damage.	Staying silent until all facts are known, or shifting blame.	A product failure or scandal and a choice of first response.

Course scope (public description): Brand Management examines how brands provide value to both consumers and organizations. Brands are a part of a consumer's everyday life and organization's strategically plan, measure, and manage brands. In this course, students will apply the strategic brand management process using a customer-based brand equity model. Students will identify how brand strategies are used and how brand associations are leveraged to create a competitive advantage. Brand equity measurement systems are explored, including brand audits and tracking studies that use qualitative and quantitative brand research techniques. Students will construct a brand architecture strategy by identifying brand extension opportunities to develop an appropriate branding strategy in a global marketplace. Reputation-management strategies and crisis management techniques are also taught to assist in preserving and protecting an organization's brand equity.